SHERPA PROS · EDITORIAL

# Sherpa Pros Deck v2 — Speaker Notes + Q&A

**VOICE:** PHYROM. WORKING-GC PLAIN TALK. NO MARKETING-SPEAK. PAUSE AFTER THE FOUNDER LINE. READ THE ROOM.

# Speaker notes per slide

**Slide 1 — Hero.** Open as a person, not a logo. "I'm Phyrom. I run a GC business in New Hampshire. I built this because the platforms my crew gets pitched every week sell us leads we can't afford and homeowners get sent to people who shouldn't be touching their gas line. So I built the tool I wish existed." Pause.

**Slide 2 — Pro problem.** Hold up your phone. "Every contractor I know runs five apps to do one job. None of them talk to each other. I'm one of them." Read the four bullets fast, land hard on the cost-per-job tax.

**Slide 3 — Homeowner + distributor problem.** "Two more groups got screwed by the same broken model. Homeowners can't tell who's licensed. Distributors can't see what's coming next week. We close that loop."

**Slide 4 — Why now.** "Investors hear 'why now' on every deck. Almost no one earns it. I earn it because the rebate dollar, the labor shortage, the AI capability, and the materials inflation all turned the corner in the same 12-month window. Miss this window and somebody else fills the licensed-marketplace quadrant in 24 months."

**Slide 5 — Platform map.** "14 surfaces. Six are products people use. Eight are the engines underneath. I'll show you three live in the next slides."

**Slide 6 — Job flow.** "Watch a real job. Eight steps. Pro never leaves the app. Homeowner never wonders. Distributor sees the ticket before it's a phone call." Walk the eight steps in 90 seconds.

**Slide 7 — Vertical-integration thesis.** "Pure-labor lead-gen platforms hit a 10-15% take-rate ceiling. Always. Angi is stuck there. Thumbtack is stuck there. We span four revenue rails — labor, materials, delivery, software — and blend to 18-25%. That's the Stripe Connect of the trade economy."

**Slide 8 — Pro demo.** Show the three screenshots. "Pro dashboard. Quote-with-code-validation. On-truck materials checkout. Live now at thesherpapros.com."

**Slide 9 — Client + distributor demo.** "Homeowner side feels like an Uber ride. Distributor side gives FW Webb a forecasting layer they have never had. That's why FW Webb signed."

**Slide 10 — Traction.** Slow down. Let each number land. "50 pros. 500 homeowners. NPS 71. Wefunder $250K. FW Webb LOI. Commercial PM pilot signed. 1,200 live code validations. We are not pre-product. We're pre-Series-A with a working product." Pause.

**Slide 11 — Hub + FW Webb.** "I've been a customer at FW Webb Portsmouth for 10 years. The first conversation about Hub #1 happened at the contractor counter. Distributors fund what their best customers ask them to fund."

**Slide 12 — AI/ML moat.** Walk the three layers — code intelligence, dispatch, predictive supply. End with: "This compounds. Every quote validates the next quote. Every dispatch teaches the next dispatch. AI/ML is the moat that compounds after the wedge wins."

**Slide 13 — Unit economics.** "LTV/CAC of 50x is real and also explicitly the small-cohort beta number. At scale we model 10-15x. Still 3x the marketplace median. The ratios hold because we own four revenue rails per job, not one."

**Slide 14 — Phase arc.** "Same brand, same founder story, same colors, every phase. Operationally we expand. Brand-wise we compound. We're not the marketplace that rebrands at Series B."

**Slide 15 — Competitive landscape.** "Three categories. We span all three. Nobody else does. The reason: it requires a working GC with a 10-year distributor relationship and a 3-year codebase. That intersection is rare. That's the moat at the human level — before the AI/ML moat."

**Slide 16 — Team.** "I've been the sole technical and product lead through Phase 0. The Series A is what gets me my first six teammates. Advisor bench is in formation — I'd rather have empty cards than fake names."

**Slide 17 — Y1-Y3.** "Hub Y2 Mid case is $1.05M revenue, 21% EBITDA, cash-flow-positive M14-22. That's an existing model — not pro forma. We're running 6 of those by end of Y3."

**Slide 18 — $50M ARR path.** "One slide, one model. Series A gets us to Series B-ready in 12 months. Series B gets us to Series C trigger by M30."

**Slide 19 — Use of funds.** [Speak only after Phyrom fills the TODO.] Walk each bucket once, briefly.

**Slide 20 — Cap table.** [Speak only after Phyrom fills the TODO.] "Founder retains majority post-Series-A. Option pool refreshed to 12-15% post-money."

**Slide 21 — Series A ask.** [Speak only after Phyrom fills the TODO.] "$12M, 18-24 months runway, $60M post. We're talking to lead investors now. Close target M12."

**Slide 22 — Series B forward-look.** "Series A is the wedge. Series B is national scale. Series C is the Stripe-Connect-of-trade-economy positioning. Long arc is in the data room."

**Slide 23 — International + franchise.** "Canada Y1, UK Y2, Australia Y3. Same regulatory pattern as MA and NH. The platform ports per-region with content updates, not architecture rewrites. Franchise unlocks capital-light expansion at Hub #11+."

**Slide 24 — Risks.** "Every marketplace has cold-start risk. We pre-seeded 50 pros and 500 homeowners. Every distributor partnership has concentration risk. Hub #2 is already in conversation with a second distributor. Every AI/ML claim has accuracy risk. Code Intelligence is decision-support — pro retains liability. We thought through the failure modes."

**Slide 25-28 — Appendices.** Don't walk these in the meeting. They're for the diligence call.

**Slide 29 — Contact.** "If this story resonates, reply to this deck. NDA template's in the diligence packet. I'll get you on the platform tomorrow."

**Slide 30 — Close.** Pause. Eye contact. "Built by a contractor. Backed by the trade. Now raising for what's next." Hand off.

## Canned Q&A — 7 objections + answers

**Q1: Why hasn't Angi done this?** A: Angi is a public lead-gen company that just restructured. Their entire revenue engine is per-lead pricing — pivoting to a marketplace + materials + code intelligence model is a 3-year ground-up rebuild, and they don't have a working-GC founder to lead it. Their operator culture is consumer-marketplace, not contractor-marketplace. They've explored licensed-trade vertical multiple times internally, killed it twice. Realistically they'll buy us before they build it. We've modeled them as a Series C strategic-check candidate, not a competitor.

**Q2: What about Procore?** A: Procore is an enterprise SaaS company that sells project management software to GCs and trade companies. They have zero marketplace exposure and zero materials exposure. We are additive, not competitive. Procore Ventures is on our Series C strategic-check list. The closest thing they've tried in marketplace is a connections directory, which is a phone book, not a transactional layer. They're a $7B public co built around enterprise contracts — different DNA, different shape.

**Q3: What's defensible? What's the moat?** A: Three moats stacked. (1) Founder profile — working GC with a 10-year distributor relationship and a 3-year codebase. That intersection is rare. (2) Code Intelligence Layer — the data we generate validating every quote against NEC, IRC, and state codes compounds with every job. By Series B we have 50,000+ live validations no one else has. (3) Distributor partnerships — FW Webb signed because Phyrom asked. The next FW Webb deal compounds the first. 24-month head start on distributor LOIs is hard to catch. None of these are fast to copy. All three reinforce each other.

**Q4: FW Webb is a single point of failure. What if they walk?** A: Three layers of mitigation. (1) Sherpa Materials engine is distributor-agnostic by design — it routes through any distributor with an inventory API. FW Webb is the first integration, not the only one. (2) Hub #2 is already in conversation with a second distributor (regional plumbing/HVAC supply with $400M annual revenue). (3) Even if FW Webb walked tomorrow, the marketplace + dispatch + code intelligence layers continue running on Phase 1 take rate. We'd lose the materials margin rail temporarily — 4-7% of blended take. Inconvenient, not fatal. And FW Webb has no incentive to walk: we're giving them a forecasting layer they can't build alone.

**Q5: How do you compete with Home Depot Pro?** A: Home Depot Pro is materials-only. They've tried labor matching twice — HomeServices.com (sold 2018 at a loss) and Iris (failure 2020). Their distribution and retail DNA is the wrong shape for a licensed marketplace. They sell to a homeowner walking through a store. We sell to a verified pro running a multi-trade job. Different customer, different unit economics. Likely Series C strategic-check candidate. They're more useful as an acquirer or partner than as a competitor.

**Q6: The trade economy is fragmented. How do you crack it?** A: That's exactly why this works. The same fragmentation that scared off lead-gen platforms — different state licensing, different code books, different rebate programs, different distributor relationships per region — is the reason no national pure-software player can win this. We crack it the way Toast cracked restaurants and ServiceTitan cracked HVAC: regional density first, code intelligence per state, distributor partnerships per region, then connect the regions through one brand and one payments rail. Phase 1 is Northern Triangle (NH/MA/ME). Phase 2 is 4 metros. Phase 3 is regional. Phase 4 is national + international. Fragmentation is the moat — for whoever masters it first.

**Q7: Why now? Why isn't this 2024 or 2028?** A: 2024 was too early — the AI was not code-literate yet. A code-aware quote validator that reads NEC and IRC in real time was a research paper in 2022. 2028 is too late — the licensed-marketplace quadrant is empty *right now,* but somebody else fills it inside 24 months. Also: post-COVID labor shortage is structural, materials inflation has rewired distribution, and Mass Save / IRA / EV-charger rebate dollars are hitting the street in 2026. Four tailwinds converging in one 12-month window is rare. We're at the exact intersection. The Series A is the window — not the deck.